

READY TO GO
Oberlin looks ready for the tournament after downing Wellington for fourth straight win. **D4**

INDIANS
Hot bats lead to win in spring opener. D2

BOYS BASKETBALL
Avon's Vega reaches another milestone. D4

SECTIONAL WRESTLING
Amherst, Columbia, Falls open strong. D8

Sports



DOUG CLARKE

Fine dining and other pleasures

The other day I sat down and penned a letter to my friend Jack Ryan, who teaches English and Film Studies at Gettysburg College. The last time I saw him was last autumn, in Cooperstown. He had to return to school before dinner. C'mon: I'll let you read over my shoulder.

Dear Jack:

Well, you were right. The monk fish and the sea bass at the Blue Mingus were so damn good we hardly missed ye. Except the girls kept insisting on giving you a salud."Salud. To Jack," they kept saying. Some of that was the martinis talking. But not all.

Listen, I have stories.

Remember how Siebenschuh kept pooh-poohing the notion of a mysterious mist rising off Lake Otsego? Well, the day after you left (that was the playoff game with the botched suicide squeeze), L and I rose early and at dawn were on the veranda of the Otesaga Hotel, watching the mist rise off the lake.

It was so thick it was spooky. L took a picture of it. Siebenschuh slept late that morning and when we saw him, L told him that the early bird gets the worm — and the mist on the lake. He waved her off. Two weeks later we casually slipped the photo in front of him as he was reading his newspaper.

What the heck is this? he demanded.

"Mist," said Leslie.

■ Incidentally, a mingus was some sort of renegade ... an outlander, of sorts ... from the Mohican tribes. We got that from our waiter. We also got free key lime pie, because he forgot to put it on the bill. I suspect his parents did not send him to school east of the Hudson River. Too bad.

■ The title of this yarn is: "Well, If That Was Norman Bates' Mother You Saw, Then Who Is That Buried In Green Lawn Cemetery?"

Seibenschuh, Gunlicke and myself went to see St. Ed's play Detroit Country Day last Thursday. Dinner at the River Wood Tavern first. We're eating Cajun burgers and a swell-dressed, smooth-talking guy stops by the table to chat with Gunlocke.

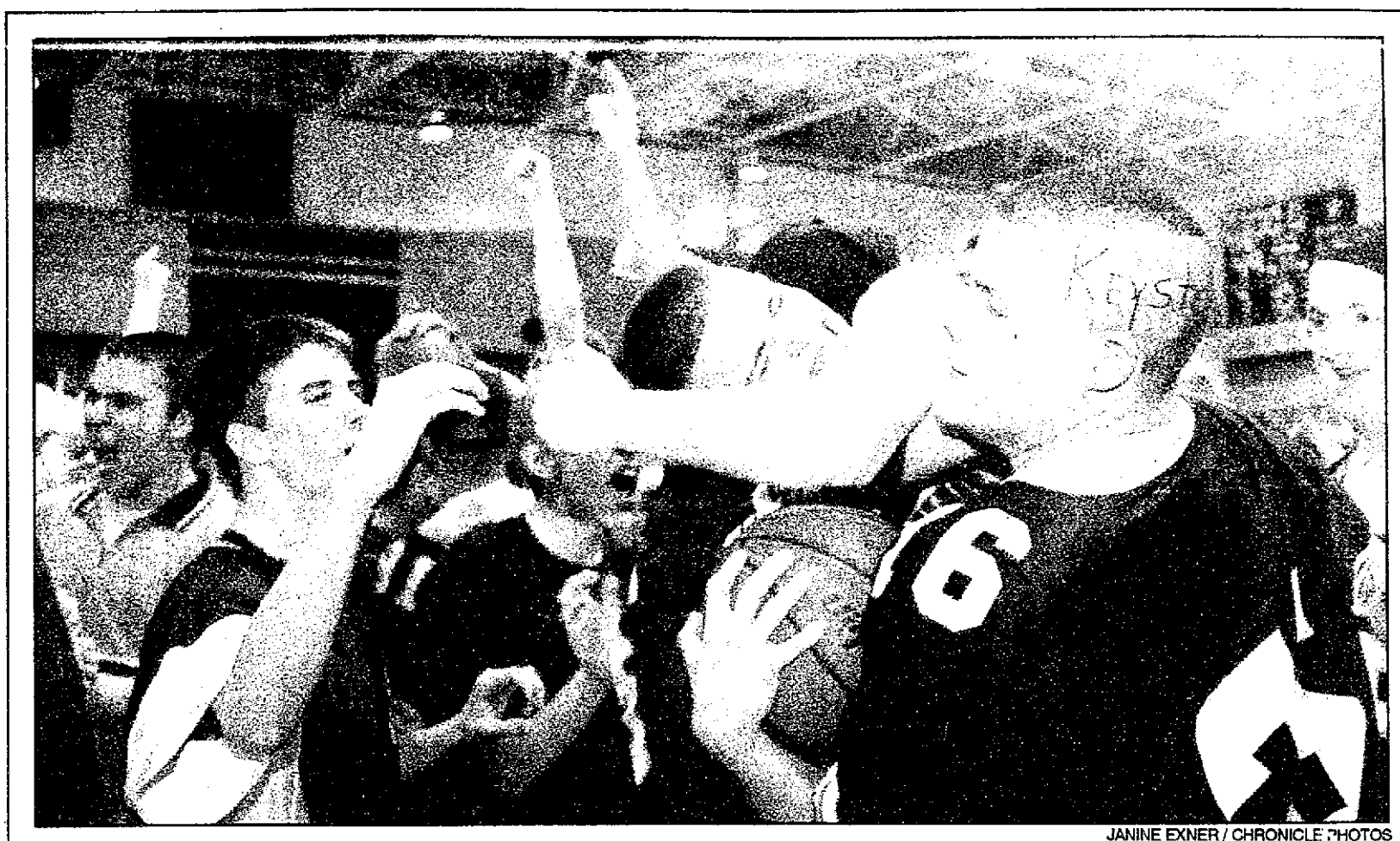
Guns tells him we're off to The Nest to watch the USA Today-ranked Eagles.

Without missing a beat, the smooth guy looks at his watch and says, "See, now there's the difference. Here it is a school night and Ignatius guys are home parsing their Latin. What's St. Ed's doing? Why, they're playing basketball."

He said it dead-pan and we crack up while smooth guy walks away. An Ignatius guy, no doubt, whose dad remembered to send him east of the Hudson to school.

As we leave the River Wood, we note that we're in good shape,

See **CLARKE,** D9



JANINE EXNER / CHRONICLE PHOTOS

CELEBRATION: Keystone fans mob Wildcat guard Todd Hodkey after the Wildcats earned a share of the LCC title.

Finally, the Cats meow

Keystone wins share of LCC with Midview

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

LAGRANGE — The nets came down as the cheers went up.

Fans rushed the court; players whooped it up. There was a postgame party on the basketball court at Keystone High School Friday night.

The Wildcats and their fans had reason to celebrate after ending a 32-year boys conference championship drought.

"This means the world to me," said Keystone center Jack Radway after a 49-46 Lorain County Conference victory over Midview. "It's been 32 years. Now we get to put something up on that banner."

"It's hard to describe," said Keystone coach Greg Morgan. "(Former coach) Steve Sayers came here nine years ago and I was his assistant. It was always our goal to win the conference — that and go to the regional.

"We haven't been to the regional, but to fill one of the goals is great."

Only one team won, but both left as champions. Midview and Keystone tied for the title.

The two rivals ended a thrilling season in the LCC with a thrilling championship game.

Midview, which had to deal with the death of Guy Pelton early in the season and an injury that sidelined standout Kyle Crawford for the big game, took the game down to the final seconds, falling short only after Brett McCort's 3-point shot fell off the iron.

"I'm about out of words," said Midview coach Troy DiFranco. "We have nothing to hang our heads about. Under adverse conditions we were down 31-19 and we never quit.

"That's been the story of the whole year. I'm so proud of them."

Midview was down 11-10 with a minute left in the first quarter. Keystone held the Middies scoreless for the next six minutes and to two points over nine minutes, going into halftime with an 18-12 advantage.

Then the Wildcats caught fire offensively in the third quarter, scoring on seven of their first eight possessions to take a 33-19 lead.

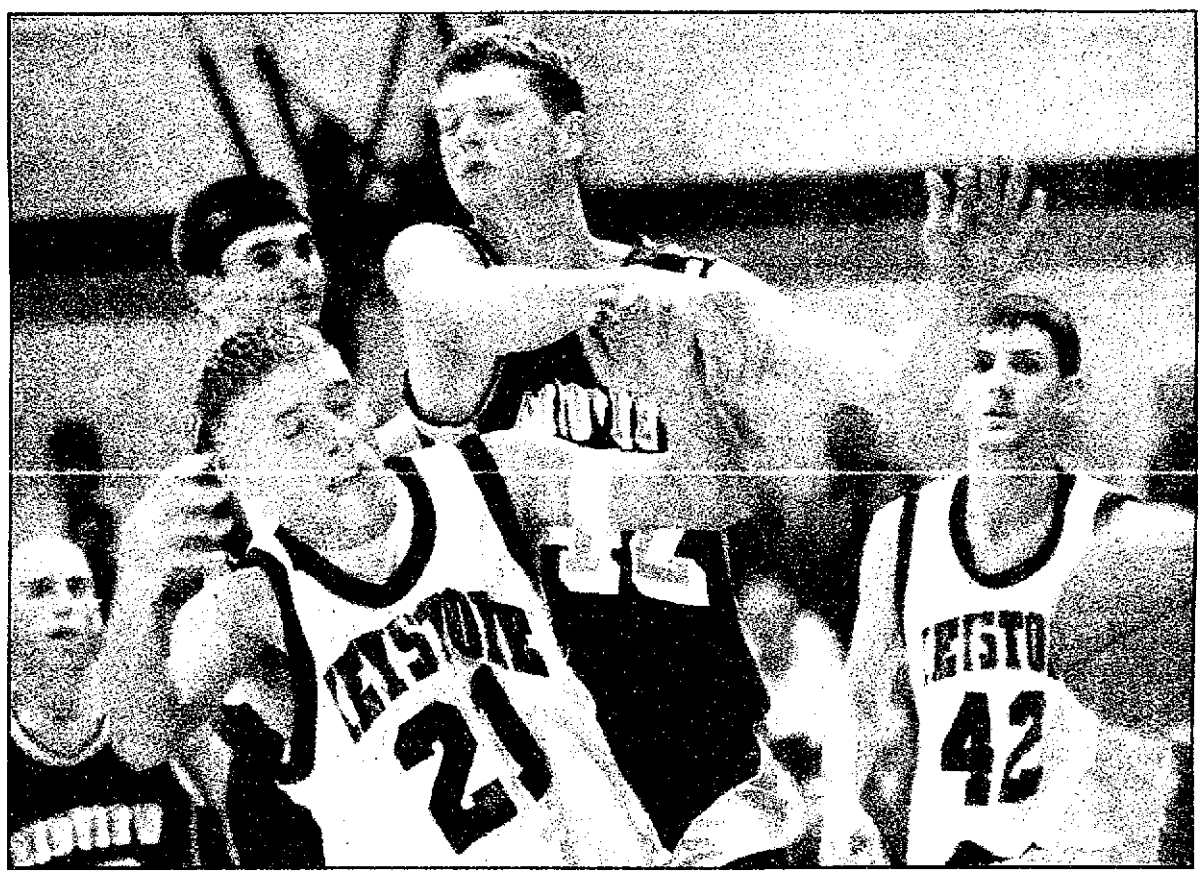
"We had a fastbreak and fumbled the ball out of bounds," Morgan said. "We could've gone up 15 or 16. That was a big momentum swing."

Midview rallied behind sophomore Doug Gerber, who sparkled all evening, especially in the second half. He scored 15 of his 21 points in the last 16 minutes, 11 in the last quarter.

Trailing 35-22, Midview clicked off eight straight points and crept to within four, 38-34, at the end of three quarters.

The Middies tied the game at 38 and 40 and had two chances to take the lead, but never did. Then Todd Hodkey made a free throw and, leading 41-40, Dave Leffew hit a 3-point shot from

See **CATS,** D9



LET'S GET PHYSICAL: Midview's Ben Elwell (42) battles Brandon Edgell of Keystone during action at Keystone Friday night in the Lorain County Conference showdown.

Falls, River share SWC

Olmsted Falls and Rocky River took care of business Friday night, with both of them winning to claim a piece of the Southwestern Conference championship.

The Bulldogs captured their third consecutive title behind a 78-59 rout of Westlake, while the Pirates walked all over North Olmsted, 80-47.

For coverage of both games, see D4.

Pistons muscle Cavs

Chris Tomasson
Knight Ridder Newspapers

AUBURN HILLS, Mich — Rick Mahorn was throwing elbows. Players were chest bumping. Bad To The Bone was blaring over the loudspeakers.

It was a scene right out of the "Bad Boys" days of the Detroit Pistons. And just as they often did during those championship years of nearly a decade ago, the Pistons were able to muscle their way to victory, defeating the Cavaliers, 90-87, on Friday night at The Palace of Auburn Hills.

"I used to see some of those Bad Boys games at the Silverdome when I was growing up," said Cavs guard Carl Thomas, a native of Lansing, Mich. "Yes, it reminded me of those games a little bit."

It was appropriate that the only two holdovers from those days played key roles for Detroit. With the clock winding down and the Cavs setting up for a 3-pointer, guard Joe Dumars was all over Wesley Person. All Person could do was throw the ball into the corner to Thomas, whose desperation shot at the buzzer missed everything.

And then there was Mahorn. Before the start of the fourth period, with Bad To The Bone blaring, a video was shown on the

See **CAVS,** D3

Elyria fights Heights

State champs get a scare

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — Perhaps tired of playing the role of the skinny kid at the beach getting sand kicked in his face, Elyria's basketball team fought back Friday night.

No, they didn't beat 10th-rated Cleveland Heights, the defending Division I state champion, but they proved to the Tigers that they still have some spunk left just the same.

Heights won the battle, 75-69, but the Pioneers certainly won the hearts of their fans.

"I'm happy for the kids," said Elyria's coach John Srnis. "They've taken a lot of garbage this year because of the scores. The kids got tired of hearing it and listening to it.

"The first step in turning this thing around is being able to

See **ELYRIA,** D8

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